

THEN & NOW

THE EARLY AMERICAN TAVERN VS THE MODERN VENUE

THE NAME HAS EVOLVED — THE PREMISE HAS NOT

THE EARLY AMERICAN TAVERN — 1634

THE HEART OF THE CITY

- **Information hub:** news, pamphlets, and dispatches arrived at the tavern first and spread outward into the community
- **Commerce engine:** goods exchanged, auctions conducted, loans arranged, mail collected and distributed
- **Political arena:** town governance, revolutionary planning, and civic debates conducted over ale
- **Physical shelter:** lodging, warmth, and medical care for travelers in an era with no alternatives
- **Social equalizer:** merchants, laborers, rebels, and officials shared the same table
- **Community anchor:** first building constructed in new settlements; towns legally required to maintain one
- **Immigrant welcome:** first stop for new arrivals — labor connections, community orientation, home away from home

Sources: *Star Tavern*, startavern.net; *American Heritage* Vol. 54 Issue 3; Colonial Williamsburg Foundation



YOUR VENUE — TODAY

A PLACE TO RELAX

- **Digital information hub:** social media check-ins, live event coverage, community communication through your venue's channels
- **Commerce engine:** POS, ticketing, merchandise, mobile ordering — the transaction layer now digital and frictionless
- **Civic gathering:** watch parties, fundraisers, team celebrations, neighborhood events — the political debate replaced by shared experiences
- **Delivering experience:** the modern "shelter" — comfort, atmosphere, escape from the demands of daily life
- **Social equalizer:** the best venues still dissolve hierarchies — fans, players, executives, and regulars at the same counter
- **Community anchor:** the neighborhood's living room — where regulars define the character of the local area
- **Tribe builder:** loyalty programs, that turn transactions into a sense of community

The name evolved. The purpose did not.

People have cherished face to face interactions since the beginning of time, and they will do so until the end of time